PROSPERITY

WHY AM I NOT PROSPEROUS?

IS IT BECAUSE PASTOR MAXWELL WON'T SELL YOU HIS PRAYERS?

IS IT BECAUSE WE DON'T DANCE AROUND AND THRASH ABOUT AND HOP UP AND DOWN SPEAKING GIBBERISH?

IS IT BECAUSE GOD IS A RESPECTER OF PERSONS?

THEN WHY?

1) WE DO NOT EVEN KNOW WHAT IT MEANS TO PROSPER.

WE DO NOT DEFINE PROSPEROUS THE SAME WAY GOD DOES.

HOW DOES GOD DEFINE PROSPEROUS?

- THE FIRST TIME "PROSPEROUS" IS FOUND IN GOD'S WORD IS IN DEUT 23:6 → THE HEBREW WORD IS ṭôb (TOBE)

- THE FIRST TIME TOBE IS FOUND IS IN GEN 1:4

Gen 1:3-4 KJV 3 And God said, Let there be light: and there was light. 4 And God saw the light, that *it was* good: and God divided the light from the darkness.

IN FACT, OVER AND OVER IN THE STORY OF CREATION WE FIND GOD SAYING "THIS IS GOOD" OR "THIS IS PROSPERITY / PROSPEROUS"

THE FIRST TIME GOD SAYS SOMETHING IS NOT GOOD / PROSPEROUS IS IN GEN 2:18 → IT IS NOT GOOD THAT THE MAN SHOULD BE ALONE.

THIS IS WHY CHURCH IS IMPORTANT
MARRIAGE
FAMILY
GHANA FOR CHRIST

A FEW OTHER THINGS GOD SAYS ARE NOT GOOD / PROSPEROUS

→ NEH 5:9 TELLS THE STORY OF BONDAGE OF OUR BRETHREN IN THE FORM OF USURY / HIGH INTEREST OR TAX (GHANAIN DUTIES)
THE INTEREST WAS SO HIGH THAT WHEN LOANS FELL BEHIND THE RICH WOULD TAKE THE LAND AND THE CHILDREN FROM THE POOR AND IT INFURIATED NEHEMIAH
WHY?
IT WAS THE CLASS SEPARATION BETWEEN THE RICH AND THE POOR
- It was premeditated injustice
- God said "You will not prosper until this is fixed"

- Prov 19:2 says it is not good / not profitable for YOU to be without knowledge.
- You will never profit until you learn to live in His Word [JOSHUA 1:8]

- PROV 24:23 SAYS YOU WILL NEVER PROSPER IF YOU ARE A RESPECTER OF PERSONS!!
  - YOU BETTER LEARN NOW TO SEE GOD'S PEOPLE THROUGH GOD'S EYES.
    [- HONORABLE AND HER GUARD]

- PROV 25:27 WARNS THAT APPETITES THAT CONTROL US WILL ROB OUR SUCCESS
  - WHEN GOD GIVES US SMALL SUCCESSES AND WE FEED OUR FLESH WITH HIS GIFTS HE WILL REMOVE HIS BLESSINGS AND FAVOR

* PROVERBS 11:27 TELLS US THAT IF WE DILIGENTLY SEEK GOD'S IDEA OF PROSPERITY WE WILL FIND IT.
- WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO DILIGENTLY SEEK?
  - EARLY
  - OFTEN
  - w/o CEASING

WHAT SHOULD WE DILIGENTLY SEEK?
- GOD'S DEFINITION OF PROSPERITY / GOOD
- WE SHOULD BE LOOKING FOR WHAT GOD IS LOOKING FOR. WE SHOULD BE SEEKING TO BE WHAT GOD IS LOOKING FOR.

What is God seeking?
1) - A heart that is perfect toward Him II CHRON 16:9
2) - Such as worship in spirit and in truth JOHN 4:23
3) - Someone to stand in the gap EZEK 22:30

1) HEART: THE EMOTIONAL SEAT OF OUR DECISION-MAKING PROCESS → DESPERATELY WICKED.
PERFECT: AT PEACE WITH GOD'S WILL

2) SPIRIT: OUT OF THE ABUNDANCE OF THE HEART THE MOUTH SPEAKETH
TRUTH: al-ay-thace' NOTHING CONCEALED → FROM THE WORD
ALPHA OR JESUS CHRIST

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